

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 47)

Page 232 - Thomas Carlyle

Q1. Which of the following works provided Carlyle with mental relief despite his acute dyspepsia?

- A. The French Revolution
- B. Sartor Resartus
- C. Past and Present
- D. Heroes and Hero-Worship

Answer: B

Q2. What translation work did Carlyle undertake during his period of hack-writing?

- A. Schiller's Dramas
- B. Goethe's Wilhelm Meister
- C. Dante's Divine Comedy
- D. Homer's Iliad

Answer: B

Q3. In what year did Carlyle publish his first important piece of independent work, Life of Schiller?

- A. 1825
- B. 1826
- C. 1834
- D. 1837

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Answer: A

Q4. Whom did Thomas Carlyle marry in 1826?

- A. Jane Austen
- B. Mary Shelley
- C. Jane Welsh
- D. Elizabeth Barrett

Answer: C

Q5. To which European literature did Carlyle contribute heavily in magazines, calling it 'a new heaven and a new earth'?

- A. French literature
- B. Italian literature
- C. Russian literature
- D. German literature

Answer: D

Q6. Where did Carlyle produce Sartor Resartus, his most characteristic book?

- A. Craigenputtoch
- B. Ecclefechan
- C. London
- D. Edinburgh

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Answer: A

Q7. In what year did Carlyle's *The French Revolution* appear?

A. 1834

B. 1837

C. 1841

D. 1843

Answer: B

Q8. Which book is considered the most penetrating of Carlyle's works inspired by critical social and industrial conditions?

A. *The French Revolution*

B. *Past and Present*

C. *Latter-day Pamphlets*

D. *Life of John Sterling*

Answer: B

Q9. What was Carlyle's last important work, published in instalments from 1858 to 1865?

A. *Past and Present*

B. *Life of John Sterling*

C. *History of Frederick the Great*

D. *Letters and Speeches of Oliver Cromwell*

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Answer: C

Q10. Where was Thomas Carlyle buried according to his own wish?

A. Westminster Abbey

B. St. Paul's Cathedral

C. Craigenputtoch

D. Ecclefechan

Answer: D

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Page 233 - Thomas Carlyle's Style and Philosophy

Q1. How did Carlyle view the merely bookish side of literature?

- A. He highly admired it
- B. He had no patience with it
- C. He considered it the highest art form
- D. He tried to master it

Answer: B

Q2. Which of Carlyle's works is described as a 'wonderful prose-epic'?

- A. Past and Present
- B. Heroes and Hero-Worship
- C. The French Revolution
- D. Sartor Resartus

Answer: C

Q3. Which seventeenth-century spirit found its last great exponent in Carlyle?

- A. Renaissance humanism
- B. Puritanism
- C. Romanticism
- D. Classicism

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Answer: B

Q4. What was the keynote of Carlyle's teaching?

- A. Optimism
- B. Sincerity
- C. Utilitarianism
- D. Materialism

Answer: B

Q5. How did Carlyle view history?

- A. As a series of random events
- B. As an illusion
- C. As 'the larger Bible'
- D. As purely secular records

Answer: C

Q6. What was Carlyle's stance on democracy?

- A. He strongly supported it
- B. He had no faith in it
- C. He believed it was the future of governance
- D. He thought it was divinely ordained

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Answer: B

Q7. Who did Carlyle believe the great masses of the people needed for guidance?

- A. The elected parliament
- B. The church clergy
- C. The 'hero' or 'able man'
- D. The wealthy aristocracy

Answer: C

Q8. What term did Carlyle use to refer to utilitarianism?

- A. Pig-philosophy
- B. Mud-gods
- C. Hero-worship
- D. Sham-philosophy

Answer: A

Q9. What did Carlyle proclaim to a generation that worshipped the 'mud-gods of modern civilisation'?

- A. A new scientific materialism
- B. A spiritual standard of life
- C. A political revolution
- D. An industrial reform

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Answer: B

Q10. Along with what did Carlyle denounce scientific materialism?

- A. Spiritual freedom
- B. Past and Present
- C. Utilitarianism
- D. Conventional religion

Answer: C

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Page 234 - John Ruskin

Q1. In what year was John Ruskin born?

- A. 1800
- B. 1819
- C. 1825
- D. 1834

Answer: B

Q2. Although born in London, what was Ruskin's familial background?

- A. Irish stock
- B. Welsh stock
- C. Scottish stock
- D. French stock

Answer: C

Q3. With which poem did Ruskin win the Newdigate prize at Oxford in 1839?

- A. Salsette and Elephanta
- B. Modern Painters
- C. Unto this Last
- D. Time and Tide

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Answer: A

Q4. What was the primary purpose of the first volume of Ruskin's Modern Painters?

- A. To criticize classic art
- B. To vindicate the genius of Turner
- C. To explore Gothic architecture
- D. To promote social propaganda

Answer: B

Q5. Which architectural work did Ruskin produce in 1849?

- A. The Stones of Venice
- B. The Seven Lamps of Architecture
- C. The Two Paths
- D. Modern Painters

Answer: B

Q6. Who did Ruskin proclaim as his master in social philosophy?

- A. Wordsworth
- B. Carlyle
- C. Turner
- D. William Morris

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Answer: B

Q7. What academic position did Ruskin hold in his later life?

- A. Regius Professor of History at Oxford
- B. Slade Professor at Oxford
- C. Professor of Poetry at Cambridge
- D. Professor of Literature at Edinburgh

Answer: B

Q8. In which series of letters to the working men of England did Ruskin expound his social ideals?

- A. Unto this Last
- B. Munera Pulveris
- C. Time and Tide by Wear and Tyne
- D. Fors Clavigera

Answer: D

Q9. Which of the following is a book by Ruskin containing his general ethical teachings?

- A. Sesame and Lilies
- B. The Stones of Venice
- C. Salsette and Elephanta
- D. Modern Painters

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Answer: A

Q10. To what did Ruskin devote most of his time and energy in his later life?

- A. Writing fiction
- B. History and theory of art exclusively
- C. Social propaganda
- D. Running a wine business

Answer: C

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Page 235 - John Ruskin's Aesthetics and Philosophy

Q1. Where did Ruskin spend the closing years of his life in failing health?

- A. Ecclefechan
- B. Coniston Water, in the Lake District
- C. Craigenputtoch
- D. London

Answer: B

Q2. Ruskin's aesthetic doctrine rests ultimately on what kind of foundations?

- A. Economic
- B. Political
- C. Moral
- D. Scientific

Answer: C

Q3. According to Ruskin, a nation can produce true art only if it is inspired by noble national aims and lives what kind of life?

- A. A pure, righteous, and happy life
- B. A wealthy and comfortable life
- C. A politically democratic life
- D. A highly educated life

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Answer: A

Q4. What did Ruskin believe was necessary before any revival of art was possible in England?

- A. Better art schools
- B. An entire change of heart (social purification)
- C. Government funding for artists
- D. A return to classical ideals

Answer: B

Q5. Ruskin's basic moral principle states that all great art is the expression of an art-gift by a what?

- A. pure soul
- B. trained mind
- C. wealthy patron
- D. romantic spirit

Answer: A

Q6. In emphasizing a constant, direct study of nature in art, whose lead was Ruskin following in poetry?

- A. Byron's
- B. Shelley's
- C. Wordsworth's
- D. Keats's

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Answer: C

Q7. What group of artists did Ruskin's philosophy specially inspire to go straight to nature?

- A. The Impressionists
- B. The Romantics
- C. The Pre-Raphaelites
- D. The Neo-Classicalists

Answer: C

Q8. Ruskin was an eloquent advocate of the claims of which type of art over classic (or pagan) art?

- A. Renaissance art
- B. Baroque art
- C. Gothic (or Christian) art
- D. Abstract art

Answer: C

Q9. What part of Ruskin's instructions did he emphasize artists must do when painting nature?

- A. Only select the beautiful parts
- B. Rejecting nothing, selecting nothing, scorning nothing
- C. Focus on the abstract forms
- D. Try to paint like famous masters

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Answer: B

Q10. Ruskin's writings fall roughly into two divisions divided by which year?

A. 1850

B. 1860

C. 1870

D. 1880

Answer: B

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Page 236 - John Ruskin and Macaulay

Q1. While Ruskin's puritanism allied him to Carlyle, his strong romantic bias connected him with whom?

- A. William Morris
- B. Walter Scott
- C. William Wordsworth
- D. John Keats

Answer: B

Q2. How was Ruskin's social and economic teaching initially received?

- A. Widely accepted as revolutionary
- B. Adopted by the government
- C. Ridiculed as hopelessly quixotic and absurd
- D. Ignored by all critics

Answer: C

Q3. Ruskin's social teachings were essentially an attempt to apply the principles of what to practical life?

- A. Utilitarianism
- B. Christianity
- C. Scientism
- D. Marxism

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Answer: B

Q4. In his denunciations of modern commercial England, Ruskin followed Carlyle's teachings and became the chief leader of whom?

- A. Matthew Arnold
- B. Thomas Babington Macaulay
- C. William Morris
- D. John Stuart Mill

Answer: C

Q5. Which of the following is cited as a fault in Ruskin's writing style?

- A. His lack of vocabulary
- B. His discursiveness and petulant manner
- C. His strict adherence to traditional forms
- D. His lack of moral conviction

Answer: B

Q6. A special feature of Ruskin's style is his marvellous power of what?

- A. Logical argumentation
- B. Word-painting
- C. Sarcastic wit
- D. Historical analysis

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Answer: B

Q7. Who was considered by contemporary opinion to hold the first place in general prose over Carlyle and Ruskin?

A. Matthew Arnold

B. William Morris

C. Thomas Babington Macaulay

D. John Henry Newman

Answer: C

Q8. In what year was Thomas Babington Macaulay born?

A. 1800

B. 1819

C. 1825

D. 1834

Answer: A

Q9. With an essay on which figure did Macaulay open a career of extraordinary success in August 1825?

A. Shakespeare

B. Spenser

C. Milton

D. Chaucer

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Answer: C

Q10. In what role did Macaulay serve in India from 1834 to 1838?

- A. Governor-General
- B. Legal adviser to the Supreme Council
- C. Military Commander
- D. Chief Justice

Answer: B